■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, September 01, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Apple says it's got the receipts on an alleged data thief*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Apple vs. OpenAI corporate espionage with named 'shocking evidence' pits two of the biggest names in tech against each other, a rivalry framing that reliably drives clicks.

The Angle: *A former Apple employee is accused of swiping company data on the way out the door to OpenAI — a juicy corporate espionage angle wrapped in the ongoing AI talent wars between Silicon Valley's biggest names.*

- **Apple** says it has **"shocking evidence"** against a former employee
- The ex-staffer is accused of **stealing company data** before allegedly heading to **OpenAI**
- Case highlights the fierce **AI talent and trade-secret war** between tech giants

The Debate Starter

- Is this cutthroat corporate sabotage or just how brutal the AI arms race has gotten?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/31/apple-shares-shocking-evidence-against-former-employee-accused-of-stealing-company-data-for-openai/

■■ *David Spade Says Jelly Roll's Trump Fat Jokes Were 'Too Many Politics'*

The Angle: *A week after Jelly Roll roasted Trump on live TV, David Spade is publicly second-guessing it - a celebrity-on-celebrity clash over whether comedy and politics should mix, which is exactly the kind of debate that gets phone lines lighting up.*

- **David Spade** publicly reacted to **Jelly Roll's** jabs at **President Trump** during his guest stint on **'Jimmy Kimmel Live!'**
- Spade admitted Jelly Roll **"got away with"** giving the president a taste of his own medicine
- Spade's overall take: there were **"too many politics"** in the bit
- The comments come one week after Jelly Roll's headline-making Kimmel appearance

The Debate Starter

- Should comedians stay out of politics, or is roasting the president fair game if you can pull it off?

TheWrap (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 85/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 28 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thewrap.com/creative-content/tv-shows/david-spade-jelly-roll-trump-fat-jokes-jimmy-kimmel/

■■ *Solar Just Dethroned Coal — In China, Of All Places*

The Angle: *China is the planet's biggest carbon emitter and its biggest coal burner, so solar overtaking coal as its top power source is a genuine world-changing milestone, not just a feel-good headline.*

- **Solar power** has now passed **coal** as China's single largest source of installed electricity capacity.
- China has been building solar and wind farms faster than any other country on the planet for years.
- The shift is a milestone in the global energy transition — even though China still burns more coal overall than any other nation.

The Debate Starter

- Is this proof the clean energy shift is unstoppable, or just a good headline out of the world's biggest coal burner?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reuters.com/business/energy/solar-overtakes-coal-chinas-largest-source-installed-power-capacity-2026-09-01/

■ *Dolly's estate is throwing her a two-day festival — in London*

The Angle: *Dolly Parton is about as universally beloved as celebrities get, so news of a festival built entirely around her legacy is instant feel-good, watercooler chatter — plus the London location is the twist nobody saw coming.*

- **Dolly Parton's estate** is organizing a **two-day festival** called **'Dollyfest'**
- The event is set to take place in **London**, not the U.S.
- It's being billed as a celebration of **Dolly's legacy**

The Debate Starter

- Why does a Tennessee icon get her tribute festival thrown across the pond instead of in Nashville?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/news/us-news/dolly-parton-estate-announces-festival-dollyfest-celebrate-legacy-rcna595468

■ *New Mexico quietly went half-renewable — and your power bill would love that*

The Angle: *A red-and-blue swing state flipped its grid majority-renewable in just five years, and somehow electricity got cheaper, not pricier — that's the exact opposite of what most people assume clean energy does to their bill.*

- **New Mexico** went from **83% fossil fuel power** to **over 50% renewable electricity** in just **five years**
- Households there pay about **14 cents per kWh**, compared to the **US average of 18 cents**
- The shift happened fast enough to raise the obvious question: why aren't more states matching this timeline

The Debate Starter

- If clean energy can mean a cheaper power bill, why does 'green' still sound expensive to most people?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://yaleclimateconnections.org/2026/08/the-state-thats-beating-dirty-electricity/

Backup options:

■ *One Slice of Kindness Now Has All of America Calling In*

The Angle: *A Bronx pizza guy saw a hungry woman digging through his trash, fed her on the spot, then put up a sign offering free slices to anyone in need - and now strangers nationwide are calling in to pay it forward. It's the kind of pure, no-strings-attached good news that makes people want to pick up the phone themselves.*

- A **Bronx pizzeria owner** noticed a woman eating food out of his trash can
- He immediately gave her a **fresh slice and a bottle of water**, no questions asked
- He then posted a **sign offering free food to anyone who's hungry**
- The story spread and people **across the US started calling to pay for slices** for strangers

The Pay-It-Forward Prompt

- Would you call a random pizzeria today just to pay for a stranger's slice?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Set Up the Chain** - Kick off the segment -> Hosts read the Bronx story cold and react live - who's touched, who's skeptical it'll last.
- **Step 2: Call a Local Spot** - Mid-segment stunt -> Producer calls a local pizzeria on air and pays it forward for the next customer, capturing their reaction.
- **Step 3: Open the Phone Lines** - Listener participation -> Ask listeners to call in with their own 'paid it forward' stories, big or small.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fox10phoenix.com/news/nyc-bronx-pizzeria-owner-sign-people-eating-trash

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■ *Russian vet's pitch to kids: learn the AK-47, conquer the world*

The Angle: *It's the kind of surreal, propaganda-meets-classroom moment that stops you mid-scroll — a real quote so on-the-nose it landed on r/nottheonion, and it taps right into the bigger story of how Russia is shaping its next generation amid the war.*

- A **Russian military veteran** reportedly told **schoolchildren** to study the **Kalashnikov rifle**
- His stated reason: **"so that the whole world speaks Russian"**
- The moment was surreal enough to get flagged on **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real stories that read like satire

The Debate Starter

- Is this just wartime bravado for the cameras, or a real look at what's being taught in Russian classrooms right now?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://novayagazeta.eu/en/articles/2026/09/01/russian-veteran-tells-schoolchildren-to-study-the-kalashnikov-rifle-so-that-the-whole-world-speaks-russian-en-news

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■ *Are tech billionaires just cosplaying bad sci-fi?*

The Angle: *This one's basically 'the boys who read too much space opera now run the world' - it's the kind of big-picture tech-culture take that gets people arguing about whether Silicon Valley's obsession with sci-fi utopias is shaping real decisions that affect all of us.*

The Debate Starter

- Which tech billionaire do you think is most obviously LARPing as a sci-fi villain (or hero) with our money and data?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theatlantic.com/books/2026/08/silicon-valley-science-fiction-jill-lepore-book-review/688467/

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■■ *MapQuest's Back, Baby — And Canada's Downloading It in Droves*

The Angle: *A map app most people forgot existed just leapfrogged Google Maps to the top of the App Store — because it refused to rename Lake Ontario. That's a nostalgia comeback story wrapped in a Canadian pride story, and it's got hosts-arguing-about-patriotism written all over it.*

- **MapQuest** — yes, that MapQuest — jumped to the **No. 1 free app** on the App Store.
- The surge reportedly came after MapQuest declined to rename **Lake Ontario**, while other big map apps went along with it.
- It's a wild turnaround for an app a lot of people assumed died with dial-up internet.

The Comeback Debate

- Would you actually switch map apps over something like this, or is this just internet noise dressed up as a boycott?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cnn.com/2026/09/01/business/mapquest-number-one-app-refusal-lake-america

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■ *Churchill's port just shipped grain to Europe—first time in 6 years*

The Angle: *A remote Manitoba port is suddenly back in the trade game, moving 30,000 tonnes of Canadian grain overseas — a small but symbolic sign of shifting trade routes and Arctic shipping potential.*

- **30,000 tonnes** of Canadian grain shipped from the **Port of Churchill** to Europe

- First shipment of its kind in **6 years**

The Quick Hit

- A tiny northern port just did something it hasn't done in six years — worth a mention, not a debate.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.marineinsight.com/port-of-churchill-ships-30000-tonnes-of-canadian-grain-to-europe-for-the-first-time-in-6-years/

■ *Carney: The U.S. Wants To Gut Our Industries*

The Angle: *Canada's Prime Minister just made a blunt public accusation against Washington — that the U.S. goal is to either kill off key Canadian industries or swallow them up as American subsidiaries. That's fighting words in an already tense trade relationship, and it's the kind of line that forces a national reaction.*

- **Mark Carney** says the **U.S.** strategy is to either **wipe out** certain Canadian industries entirely or turn them into **subsidiaries** of American companies.
- The comment lands amid ongoing friction between **Ottawa** and **Washington** over trade and economic sovereignty.

The Debate Starter

- Is Carney standing up for Canadian industry here, or just posturing ahead of the next round of trade talks?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/world/trumps-tariffs/article/carney-says-us-wants-to-wipe-out-canadian-industries-or-make-them-subsidiaries/

Backup options:

■ *Americans push back on Trump's Canada tariffs and the Lake Ontario rename*

The Angle: *A new Reuters/Ipsos poll shows most Americans aren't on board with Trump's latest Canada tariffs or his idea to rename Lake Ontario - a rare case of US public opinion siding with Canada in the trade fight.*

- **Reuters/Ipsos poll** finds a **majority of Americans** oppose the new **Canada tariffs**
- Same poll shows Americans also reject the idea of **renaming Lake Ontario**
- Story is circulating on **r/canada**, framed as Americans siding with Canada against their own president's moves

The Debate Starter

- Does it change how Canadians feel about the trade fight knowing most Americans think it's a bad idea too?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/world/trumps-tariffs/article/majority-of-americans-oppose-trumps-new-canada-tariffs-renaming-lake-ontario-reutersipsos-poll-finds/

■■ *Carney runs the table — sweeps all three byelections*

The Angle: *A clean sweep in byelections is a strong signal for a sitting PM, and it locks in Carney's majority — a real gauge of whether Canadians are still buying what the Liberals are selling.*

- **PM Mark Carney** and the **Liberals** won all **three** federal byelections held.
- The sweep allows the Liberals to hold onto their **parliamentary majority**.
- One Liberal figure was quoted calling it **'a great time to be a Liberal.'**

The Debate Starter

- Is this a real vote of confidence in Carney, or just low-turnout byelection noise that won't mean much at the next general election?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/a-great-time-to-be-a-liberal-pm-carney-sweeps-all-three-byelections-holds-onto-majority/

■■ *Newfoundland goes missing on Canada's most iconic notebook*

The Angle: *Back-to-school shopping just got awkward in Newfoundland and Labrador — the map on the cover of the classic Hilroy exercise book apparently leaves the province off entirely, and parents buying supplies are noticing.*

- The story centers on **Hilroy** exercise books — a Canadian school-supply staple for generations.
- Parents and students shopping for **back-to-school supplies** spotted the map issue on the cover.
- Residents of **Newfoundland and Labrador** are described as **shocked** and demanding answers.

The Regional Pride Trigger

- Newfoundlanders, be honest — how many times have you had to defend your province's existence on a map?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/newfoundland-labrador/hilroy-exercise-books-nl-9.7328176?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Rob Reiner's son got married and nobody knew*

The Angle: *A quiet celebrity wedding with a fun reveal — Jake Reiner showed up wearing a wedding band before anyone even knew he'd tied the knot, so the story is basically a real-life 'wait, when did THAT happen?' moment.*

- **Jake Reiner**, 35 — **Rob and Michele Reiner's** eldest son — reportedly married **Maria Gilfillan** earlier this month
- **TMZ** broke the news Monday
- The wedding band was spotted on his left ring finger during a recent interview, tipping people off before any announcement
- It's still unclear exactly how long Jake and Maria have been married

The Watercooler Take

- Would you rather do the big public wedding or just quietly get married and let people find out later?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/31/celebrity-news/rob-and-michele-reiners-son-jake-is-married-report/

■ *Idiocracy Called It — And Now It's Too Real*

The Angle: *Mike Judge's 2006 flop-turned-cult-classic predicted a dumbed-down future so accurately that two decades later it plays less like satire and more like a documentary — that's the kind of "we're living in the meme" moment that gets a studio talking.*

- **Mike Judge's** "Idiocracy" hit theaters back in **2006** and barely got released, only to become a cult classic years later.
- The film has become internet shorthand — people invoke "**we're living in Idiocracy**" any time reality feels like it's outrunning the joke.
- Retrospective take marking the **20-year anniversary** argues the comedy hits differently now that some of its dumbed-down-future gags feel less far-fetched.

The Debate Starter

- What's the one modern headline that sounds like it was ripped straight out of Idiocracy?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.texasmonthly.com/culture/mike-judge-idiocracy-turns-20/

■ *CBS staffers reportedly furious over 'racist' story on Bari Weiss' watch*

The Angle: *Bari Weiss took over as CBS News editor-in-chief promising to shake up the newsroom - now insiders are reportedly calling one of her stories 'shameful' and accusing it of 'overt racism,' which is exactly the kind of internal media drama that gets people talking.*

- Report centers on **Bari Weiss**, now running editorial at **CBS**

- Staffers reportedly calling a recent story **'shameful'**
- Internal accusations point to **'overt racism'** in the piece
- Framed as a brewing **newsroom revolt** at the network

The Debate Starter

- Is this a legit editorial reckoning at CBS, or just staffers who never wanted Bari Weiss running the place in the first place?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.rawstory.com/bari-weiss-anti-muslim-racism/

■ *Olivia Rodrigo just quietly raised $20 million for women and girls*

The Angle: *Olivia Rodrigo isn't just topping charts, she's using her tour platform to move real money to causes for women and girls, and it's the kind of celebrity philanthropy story that actually has substance behind it.*

- Olivia Rodrigo's music festival/tour effort raised **$20 million USD** for charity.
- The funds are earmarked for organizations that support **women and girls**.
- It positions Rodrigo among the more active young pop stars using tour proceeds for direct charitable giving.

The Debate Starter

- Is this the new blueprint for pop star philanthropy, or does it feel more meaningful when a young artist earmarks tour cash for causes like this?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/rodrigo-daisy-chain-fields-9.7327187

Backup options:

■ *Lanterns Writer Claps Back at the 'Woke' Crowd*

The Angle: *Another superhero project, another online fight over diversity — the writer behind HBO's Lanterns is pushing back on fans slamming John Stewart's storyline as 'woke,' and that's exactly the kind of culture-war entertainment beef that gets phone lines lit up.*

The Debate Starter

- Is 'woke' just become code for 'a Black superhero got the spotlight,' or do fans have a real gripe with the writing?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.superherohype.com/news/689791-lanterns-john-stewart-woke-backlash-response

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■ *Blue Beetle's back — James Gunn just made it official*

The Angle: *Fans feared Blue Beetle got quietly buried after DC's shakeup, so confirming Xolo Maridueña returns in Gunn's next chapter is a genuine relief-and-hype moment for a fanbase that's been burned before.*

- **Xolo Maridueña** is officially confirmed to reprise his role as **Blue Beetle**
- The character returns in **James Gunn's** upcoming DCU film **'Man of Tomorrow'**
- Comes after fan speculation the character might be sidelined following the 2023 solo film's box office struggles

The Fan Relief Bit

- Did you write off Blue Beetle after last year, or did you always think Gunn had a plan for him?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://variety.com/2026/film/news/xolo-mariduena-blue-beetle-james-gunn-superman-sequel-1236847961/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

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■ *170+ Jewish Creatives Just Went to Bat for Mark Ruffalo*

The Angle: *Paramount accusing a major A-lister of using 'antisemitic tropes' is already a jaw-dropper, but when Hannah Einbinder, Joel Coen and over 170 Jewish industry figures publicly fire back with an open letter, that's a full-blown Hollywood standoff hosts can dig into.*

- **Paramount** publicly accused **Mark Ruffalo** of using **'antisemitic tropes'**
- **Hannah Einbinder** and **Joel Coen** are among those defending him
- More than **170 Jewish figures** in the industry signed an **open letter** in his support

The Debate Starter

- Is this a studio holding a star accountable, or Hollywood politics turning an actor into a target?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/mark-ruffalo-open-letter-antisemitism-claims-paramount-1236848093/

■ *Gal Gadot picks another fight — this time it's AI vs. Hollywood*

The Angle: *Gadot has a well-documented streak of landing on the unpopular side of internet debates, and now she's reportedly weighing in to defend AI's use in movies — a subject that still has actors, writers, and fans extremely touchy after the strikes.*

- **Gal Gadot** is reportedly speaking out in defense of using **AI in movies**
- The take is already making the rounds on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, a hub for celebrity discourse and dragging

The Debate Starter

- Is it tone-deaf for an A-list actor to defend AI in film, or is Hollywood just going to have to make peace with it?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/m4tr2wc5lumh1.png

TRENDING TODAY

■■ *Bentley just built its lightest car since WWII*

The Angle: *It's a car story with a fun hook - a luxury brand known for plush, heavy interiors going full stripped-down speed machine, which is a great excuse to talk about what you'd cut to save weight.*

- The **Bentley Supersports** is being called the **lightest Bentley in 85 years**.
- It's described as a stripped-out, engineer-focused build rather than a luxury cruiser.

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather have a Bentley loaded with luxury features or a stripped-down version built purely for speed?

Ars Technica (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/cars/2026/08/the-bentley-supersports-a-stripped-out-engineers-indulgence/

Backup options:

■■ *Shein finally goes public — but not where you'd think*

The Angle: *Shein spent years trying to list in New York and London and got shut down both times over forced-labor concerns in its factories — now it's debuting in Hong Kong instead, and that says a lot about how the ultra-cheap fashion empire is viewed in the West.*

- **Shein** lists on the **Hong Kong Stock Exchange** on **Tuesday**
- The company tried for years to go public in **New York** and **London** first
- **US lawmakers** blocked those plans over allegations of **forced labor** in Shein's factories
- Shein says it has taken steps to address the allegations

The Debate Starter

- Would knowing about the forced-labor allegations actually stop you from ordering from Shein?

BBC News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c3v0qrz7z25o

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Principal has minutes to act, saves every single kid*

The Angle: *A glacier flood was barreling toward a Nepal school and this principal had almost no warning — he got over 1,600 kids out and turned the buses around before the building was swept away. It's the kind of story that makes you ask what you'd do with two minutes and a thousand lives on the line.*

- A glacier triggered a sudden, devastating flash flood near the school
- The principal evacuated **1,643 children** in the chaos
- He turned incoming **buses back** before they reached danger
- Every single child survived — the school itself was swept away by the flood

The Feel-Good Trigger

- This is one of those 'restore your faith in humanity' stories — who's the one teacher or coach who kept YOU safe in a crisis?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.indiatoday.in/world/story/nepal-flash-floods-teacher-rajendra-dadabi-saved-1643-children-trishuli-valley-nuwakot-2982813-2026-08-30

Backup options:

■ *New Sugar Is 3,500 Times Sweeter—Zero Calories, Zero Insulin Spike*

The Angle: *Everyone's looking for a sugar swap that doesn't feel like a compromise, and this one claims to check every box — insane sweetness, no calories, no blood sugar spike. It's the kind of 'too good to be true' science headline that gets people arguing about artificial sweeteners.*

- New compound measures in at **3,500 times sweeter** than regular table sugar (sucrose)
- Billed as **zero-calorie**
- Researchers say it does **not spike insulin** the way regular sugar does

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually eat a lab-made super-sweetener, or does 'doesn't spike insulin' sound too good to be true?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/this-new-zero-cal-sugar-is-3500-times-sweeter-than-sucrose-but-doesnt-spike-insulin

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■ *New Study Says Being Chill About Solo Sex Boosts Your Confidence*

The Angle: *It's a Reddit science thread with real data behind a topic everyone has an opinion on but rarely talks about out loud - the link between attitude and self-esteem is the kind of thing that gets a studio arguing in seconds.*

- People with **positive views on masturbation, oral sex, and anal sex** reported higher **sexual pleasure and satisfaction**
- Same group scored higher on **sexual self-efficacy** - basically confidence in the bedroom
- **Accepting attitudes toward masturbation** specifically tracked with better outcomes across **all four domains** studied
- Study is circulating on **r/science**, sparking debate over lingering taboos

The Phone-In Trigger

- Do you think we're still weirdly judgmental about masturbation - and is that actually hurting people's confidence?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/favorable-attitudes-toward-diverse-sexual-practices-predict-higher-sexual-well-b/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *5,000 US Sailors Hit Thailand After 200 Days at Sea*

The Angle: *This is peak 'not the onion' material — a literal news brief about vice patrols bracing for thousands of sailors coming off a 200-day deployment, which is exactly the kind of absurd-but-real headline that makes for an easy, fun kicker.*

- **5,000 US sailors** are reportedly making port in **Thailand**
- The crew is coming off **200 days at sea** — that's over six months without shore leave
- Local prostitution/vice patrols are said to be on **high alert** ahead of their arrival

The Debate Starter

- 200 days at sea with no shore leave — what's the first thing YOU'D do on dry land?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/pattaya-police-intensify-prostitution-patrols-us-navy-visit-1763395

Backup options:

■ *Rental EV, $418 Charging Bill... From a FREE Charger*

The Angle: *It's the classic rental-car horror story with an EV twist - the driver thought they were doing the smart, responsible thing by charging up, and got nuked with a bill anyway. Instant relatable outrage for anyone who's ever rented a car.*

- Renter plugged in at a **dealer's public charging station** - the kind meant to be free or low-cost for customers
- Ended up slapped with a **$418 charging bill** after returning the car
- Story blew up on **Reddit's r/nottheonion** as a case of 'you can't make this up'
- Highlights the fine print/fee traps still being worked out in the **EV rental space**

The Phone-In Trigger

- Have you ever gotten hit with a bogus rental car fee that made zero sense - what was it and how much did they nick you for?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thedrive.com/news/ev-renter-hit-with-418-charging-bill-after-using-dealers-public-charger

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 0/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *B.C. Dad Picks Up Rattlesnake, Son Gets Bitten*

The Angle: *A prime 'r/nottheonion' dad-fail story — a father in B.C. handled a rattlesnake and his kid ended up bitten, then owned it with the understatement of the year. Pure kicker gold: cringe, comedy, and a built-in quote.*

- A father in **British Columbia** picked up a rattlesnake — and it bit his young son.
- His own recap of the incident: **"We made a few mistakes."**
- Story's been making the rounds on **Reddit's r/nottheonion**.

The Confession Booth

- What's the most 'we made a few mistakes' moment from your own parenting?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://theprprovince.com/news/bc-boy-bitten-by-rattlesnake-his-father-picked-up-we-made-a-few-mistakes/wcm/240b1d1a-5688-4fd2-a2ae-b6c4c1975728

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *91-Year-Old Just Took Back His Hiking World Record*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A 91-year-old reclaiming an endurance record is a rare feel-good underdog narrative with a memorable nickname ('Grey Beard') that human-interest aggregators love to pick up.
The Angle: *A 91-year-old reclaiming the title of oldest person to finish the entire Appalachian Trail is the kind of feel-good, defy-your-age story that spreads fast online - it's a built-in mood-lifter and a great excuse to talk about what "too old" really means.*

- **Dale 'Grey Beard' Sanders**, age **91**, has reclaimed the record for oldest person to complete the **Appalachian Trail**.
- The **Appalachian Trail** runs roughly **2,190 miles** end to end - not a small walk in the woods.
- This is being framed as him taking the record *back*, suggesting he'd held it before and lost it.

The Inspiration Angle

- Phones open: what's the one thing you're determined to still be doing at 91?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ksl.com/article/news/features/odds-and-ends/at-91-dale-grey-beard-sanders-reclaims-record-as-oldest-hiker-to-complete-the-appalachian-trail/51618285

■ *Star Wars game becomes a hit — right as its makers get furloughed*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Furloughing most staff right after a hit Star Wars game launch is a jarring hypocrisy angle that gaming press and fans amplify fast.
The Angle: *A brand-new Star Wars game is landing as a genuine hit, but reports say studio bosses quietly furloughed most of the team right before launch — a gut-punch timing story that taps into the bigger conversation about how the gaming industry treats its workers even when a project succeeds.*

- The game is **Star Wars Zero Company** - reportedly a hit right out of the gate.
- Studio leadership allegedly furloughed **"most"** staff.
- The furloughs reportedly happened **quietly**, just before the game's launch.

The Debate Starter

- Should a studio be allowed to furlough the team right as their game blows up - or does a hit launch mean the people who built it deserve job security, not layoffs?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.ign.com/articles/the-studio-behind-hit-new-star-wars-game-zero-company-quietly-furloughed-most-staff-just-before-launch

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■ *Read John Ternus's full memo to Apple employees on first day as CEO: "We're lucky to have a CEO who led with his values with decency and humanity. I'm honored to be stepping into role at what is truly the greatest company in the world. We have a huge launch next week that's going to be phenomenal."*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A new Apple CEO's first-day memo is a rare, high-profile corporate leadership moment with a big enough name to draw outsized attention beyond its current engagement.
The Angle: *Read John Ternus's full memo to Apple employees on first day as CEO: "We're lucky to have a CEO who led with his values with decency and humanity. I'm honored to be stepping into role at what is truly*

the greatest company in the world. We have a huge launch next week that's going to be phenomenal."

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://9to5mac.com/2026/09/01/read-new-apple-ceo-john-ternuss-full-memo-to-employees/

■ *Alex Cooper's Dating Show Walks the Plank*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Alex Cooper is one of the biggest names in podcasting/media right now, and a surprise one-season cancellation of her show is exactly the kind of quick-turn entertainment news that spikes.
The Angle: *Alex Cooper is one of the biggest names in podcasting right now, so any stumble as she branches into TV producing is instant gossip - and a one-season cancellation is a juicy "did it flop" storyline for hosts to dig into.*

- **Alex Cooper's** reality dating show **'Love Overboard'** has been canceled by **Hulu**
- The show is done after just **one season**

The Hot Take

- Is reality dating TV just oversaturated right now, or did 'Love Overboard' specifically miss the mark?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.usmagazine.com/entertainment/news/alex-coopers-love-overboard-show-canceled-after-1-season/?utm_medium=lBQMjkx&utm_source=liqsoc

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■ *Olivia Rodrigo's Dress Was Actually a Political Statement*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Olivia Rodrigo's dress choice tied to a Palestinian brand combines A-list celebrity with a politically charged, emotionally resonant statement ('we have not been forgotten') that tends to travel.
The Angle: *Olivia Rodrigo stepped out in a custom piece from Palestinian label Nöl Collective, and the founder says it was a lifeline for visibility during the war in Gaza — a reminder that celebrity fashion choices can carry real political weight, not just red-carpet buzz.*

- **Olivia Rodrigo** wore a custom dress designed by Palestinian brand **Nöl Collective**.
- Founder **Yasmeen Mjalli** said the moment helped say: **"We are still here; we have not been forgotten."**
- Mjalli added the gesture **"meant the world to us."**

The Debate Starter

- Is a celebrity wearing the right label real solidarity, or just a good PR moment — where's the line?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1w4xqkh

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 14 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)

- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal’s Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "‘Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she’s sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)
- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt ‘Disappointed’ by BLACKPINK’s 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite’s ‘Override’ Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary ‘B’Day’ Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "‘A modern Dickie Dee bike’: Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-01 11:41 PM